

Day 2 — Vāta — The Motion Principle

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify vāta-style behaviours (quick, dry, cold, moving) in self and surroundings.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *vāta* (IAST: vāta; lit. “motion principle (wind, ākāśa+vāyu)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Observe motion.** Watch a leaf in a draft, a flag on a breezy day, or a fan spinning. “*What do you notice about the air’s qualities? Is it predictable or changeable?*”
2. **Define vāta.** Motion principle. Five subtypes are described in Caraka:
 - *prāṇa* — inhalation, heart, head
 - *udāna* — speech, exhalation
 - *samāna* — digestion, equilibrium
 - *apāna* — elimination, downward flow
 - *vyāna* — circulation, full-body movement
3. **Vāta qualities (guṇas):** dry, light, cold, rough, subtle, mobile, clear. Have students list one observation matching each quality.
4. **Source.** Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 12 enumerates *vāta-prakopa* (vāta aggravation) signs: dry skin, restless sleep, anxiety, irregular digestion. Read one paragraph.
5. **Modern bridge.** *Vāta* maps loosely to *autonomic nervous-system arousal patterns* and *peristaltic / circulatory rhythms*. Be careful: this is a wellness lens — NOT diagnosis.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Vāta — The Motion Principle.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).